

Ushasi Banerjee

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Education

- 2020–2026 **Ph.D in Linguistics**, Yale University, New Haven, CT
Dissertation title: *Khasi, Mizo, and a Theory of crosslinguistic variation in the nominal domain*
Advisor: Veneeta Dayal
Committee: Zoltán Gendler Szabó, Jim Wood, and Ayesha Kidwai (*external*)
- 2016–2018 **M.A in Linguistics**, English and Foreign Languages University, Hyderabad, India
Primary mentor: Utpal Lahiri
- 2013–2016 **B.A in English**, English and Foreign Languages University, Hyderabad, India

Research

- AREAS Formal Semantics, Morphology, Semantics Fieldwork for under-documented languages, Typology
- INTERESTS: Numeral classifiers, Number marking, Non-counting plurals, Demonstratives and Definiteness determiners, Bare nouns and Kinds
- FIELDWORK: Austroasiatic: Khasi, Pnar. Tibeto-Burman: Mizo, Mongsen Ao.

Teaching

- Spring 2026 Teaching Fellow for *Phonology I*, Instructor: Natalie Weber, Yale University
- Fall 2025 Teaching Fellow for *Semantics I*, Instructor: Simon Charlow, Yale University
- Spring 2024 Teaching Fellow for *Pragmatics*, Instructor: Laurence Horn, Yale University
- Fall 2023 Teaching Fellow for *Introduction to Linguistics*, Instructor: Jim Wood, Yale University
- Spring 2023 Teaching Fellow for *Cognitive Science of Language*, Instructor: Robert Frank, Yale University
- Fall 2022 Teaching Fellow for *Semantics I*, Instructor: Veneeta Dayal, Yale University
- Fall 2019 Teaching Fellow for *Introduction to Formal Semantics*, Instructor: Utpal Lahiri, English and Foreign Languages University

Fellowships and Awards

- 2026 MacMillan Center International Conference Travel Grant, Yale University
- 2020–2026 Yale Graduate School of Arts and Sciences Fellowship (tuition and stipend)
- 2024 MacMillan International Dissertation Research Fellowship, Yale University
- 2023 Linguistic Society of America Summer Program Award, Yale University
- 2019 CreteLing Summer School Fellowship, CreteLing Organizers
- 2018 Junior Research Fellowship (UGC-NET JRF), University Grants Commission India (awarded to the top 10% of students taking the competitive NET exam)

Publications

Journals (TBS = To be submitted)

- In prep **Banerjee, Ushasi**, Dee Chhange, and Bianca Nongkynrih. Bare nouns and reference in some languages of Northeast India. To be submitted to *Language: Research Reports*
- TBS **Banerjee, Ushasi**. A Universal account for Numeral Classifiers: typological perspectives. *Glossa*.
- Under Review **Banerjee, Ushasi**. What Mizo reveals about the Architecture of D-Expressions. *Natural Language & Linguistic Theory*.

Conference Proceedings

- To appear **Banerjee, Ushasi**. (De)composing Reference: typological perspectives. *Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)* 36.
- 2024 **Banerjee, Ushasi**. Accounting for counting (crosslinguistically). *Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)* 34: 713-733.
<https://doi.org/10.3765/c5vw5q42>
- 2023 Yip, Ka Fai, **Ushasi Banerjee**, and Margaret Chui Yi Lee. Are there "weak" definites in bare classifier languages?. *Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)* 33: 253-275.
<https://doi.org/10.3765/56xkxm29>
- 2018 Meghavarshini Krishnaswamy, Indranil Dutta, and **Ushasi Banerjee**. Evidence for active cavity expansion through advanced lingual place of constriction in voiced geminates, *The Journal of Acoustical Society in America*, Vol 153, No. 1.
<https://doi.org/10.1121/1.5035741>
- 2018 **Banerjee, Ushasi**, Indranil Dutta, and Irfan. S. Coarticulatory propensity in Khalkha Mongolian, ACL Anthology, *Proceedings of 14th International Conference on Natural Language Processing*

Presentations

- 2026 Deictic definites in Mizo: a decomposable account of D-expressions. *Semantics and Linguistic theory* 36, University of Buenos Aires. Poster. (upcoming)
- 2024 Accounting for counting (crosslinguistically). *Semantics and Linguistic theory* 34, University of Rochester. Talk.
- 2023 Are there "weak" definites in bare classifier languages?. *Semantics and Linguistic theory* 33, Yale University. Talk. (with Ka Fai Yip and Margaret Chui Yi Lee)
- 2023 Khasi as a Classifier language. *(In)definiteness and genericity across languages SALT 33 satellite sessions*, Yale University. Poster.
- 2022 Some question particles in Bangla and where to find them. *Language Diversity, Linguistic Theory and Cultural Identity in South Asia (LDSA)*, Yale University. Poster.
- 2019 Modals in Bangla: Interaction with Tense and Aspect. *Creteling Poster Sessions, University of Crete, Greece*. Poster.
- 2018 Coarticulatory Propensity in Khalkha Mongolian. *International Conference on Natural Language Processing (ICON), India*. Poster. (with Indranil Dutta)

Other research and study experience

Research

- 2025 (online) Fieldwork, Project: Deictic definites and demonstratives in Mizo
- 2025, 2024 (on-site) Fieldwork in Meghalaya, Project: Classifiers and plural marking in Khasi
- 2024 (on-site) Fieldwork in Mizoram, Project: Bare nouns and (in)definiteness in Mizo
- 2017 Building an automatic speech detection system for Naga languages, Indian Institute of Technology, Guwahati. Supervisor: Shakuntala Mahanta

Study

- 2023 LSA Linguistic Institute, Linguistic Society of America, University of Massachusetts, Amherst.
- 2019 Creteling Summer School, University of Greece, Rethymnon
- 2017 QIP-CEP Workshop on Experimental & Empirical Methods in Linguistics, Indian Institute of Technology, New Delhi.

Academic Service

- 2026 Reviewer, Semantics of Natural Languages
- 2024 Reviewer, NELS abstracts
- 2022 Co-Organizer, SNEWS at Yale University
- 2022 Website designer: Language Diversity, Linguistic Theory and Cultural Identity in South Asia (LDSA) at Yale University
- 2021–2022 Organizer, Semantics Reading Group at Yale

Skills

Languages	<i>Native/near-native</i>	<i>Fieldwork/research</i>	<i>Coursework</i>
	Bangla	Khasi	ASL
	English	Mizo	Spanish
	Hindi	Mongsen Ao	
		Yoruba	
		Khalkha Mongolian	
Computing	L ^A T _E X, Python, R, Ruby		

References

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Zoltán Szabó

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